

Chawla: Mr Gogoi, would you agree that you don't spend enough on the development of rural areas?

Tarun Gogoi, chief minister, Assam: This is the first time the Centre has given priority to rural areas. I am also giving priority to the rural areas, as I have been doing for education. I want a model school in every block.

Chawla: The maximum amount of Central subsidy goes to the North-East. What kind of development have you achieved?

Gogoi: Because of the creation of East Pakistan, our road links had been disrupted; the rail links had been disrupted; the river links had been disrupted. The whole area had been landlocked. We came late in the education field also. Now I have passed a Bill for private universities. But very few will come immediately.

Chawla: Mr Kamat, any demand from your side for the finance minister? The Congress chief ministers are a little liberal, it seems. They are satisfied.

Digambar Kamat, chief minister, Goa: Goa suffered a lot because of the Gadgil formula. It helped those states which did not perform and punished those which did. After Mr Chida-

"Only 5 per cent of our population is vocationally trained. We need to make people employable to promote growth."

RAVI PARTHASARATHY
CHAIRMAN & MD, IL&FS



mbaram took over, the entire system of funding the states got changed.

Chawla: I think another North-East state has something to say to Mr Chidambaram in terms of infrastructure or agriculture.

Dr Lalzama, education minister, Mizoram: Mizoram depends on agriculture but the produce has to be transported and the construction of roads is very difficult there. We want the Centre to help fund the agricultural ring road.

Chawla: DMK has got all the good ministries at the Centre and whatever extra you want, you can ask.

Thangam Thennarasu, minister for school education, Tamil Nadu: We have done a lot for our farmers. When we took over last year, we waived co-operative loans of Rs 7,000 crore. This will help our farmers to a great extent.

Chawla: I have been trying for a common minimum political consensus. But they come back to the same thing—I am not getting this, I am not getting that.

Chidambaram: These criticisms are exaggerated and misplaced. For example, the last NDC meeting, for the first time, was exclusively devoted to agriculture. We adopted a resolution in which the Centre and the states accepted six obligations each. If all of them are implemented, India's agriculture will be back on the 4-plus per cent growth track.

Chawla: The solution for agriculture is in implementing the agreed formula. Let us agree on that and move on. Mr Ravi Parthasarathy, chairman and MD of IL&FS, will make a short presentation on skill development for inclusive growth.



4. Mizoram Education Minister Dr Lalzama, 5. Delhi Chief Minister Sheila Dikshit, 6. Assam Chief Minister Tarun Gogoi, 7. Tamil Nadu Education Minister Thangam Thennarasu, 8. Goa Chief Minister Digambar Kamat, 9. Orissa Urban Development Minister K.V. Singh Deo

Ravi S Sahni

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